

FZQA AIRPORT – UPDATE ON RUNWAY CONDITION AND PERFORMANCE CONSIDERATIONS

Background

Following recent reports that have been received, it is observed that there is a lack of awareness on FZQA(FBM), Lubumbashi. To raise both the pre-flight awareness of issues related to the airport and the NOTAM update, this bulletin is prepared.

Reported Operational Hazards and Considerations

1. Runway Characteristics

The short runway limitation previously reported has been resolved; full length (3200 m) is now available.

180° turn required at RWY 07/25 rack for large aircraft during taxi, take-off, or landing, crews should plan and execute with caution due to limited turning space.

Based on recent NOTAMs effective 11–30 November 2025 indicate that FZQA Airport's runway (RWY 07/25) is now fully usable along its entire 3200-meter length. Associated lighting, PAPI for RWY 07, and ILS/DME installations are operational throughout this period.

2. Environmental and Performance Factors

High elevation combined with high ambient temperatures significantly impacts aircraft performance.

Crews should anticipate longer take-off rolls, reduced climb performance, and landing distance considerations.

Performance calculations must account for density altitude effects.

3. Surface and Atmospheric Conditions

Reports indicate light to moderate turbulence may be experienced on or near the runway surface, particularly during take-off and landing phases.

4. Fuel and Go-Around Considerations

Limited fuel availability for multiple approach attempts may result in increased crew workload and reduced safety margins.

Thorough fuel and alternate planning is essential prior to departure to/from FZQA.



Flight. Ops. Safety

Recommendations

- Conduct comprehensive pre-flight performance analysis considering elevation, temperature, and aircraft weight.
- Ensure accurate fuel planning with contingencies for possible go-arounds or holding.
- Maintain situational awareness during runway 180° turns and when operating near terrain or turbulence-prone areas.
- Brief all crew members on airport-specific threats and mitigation strategies prior to operation.

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SAFE FLIGHT!!